

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on experience managing cases from instruction through to completion, preparing documents and bundles, maintaining organised matter records and communicating with clients across a range of legal settings. Practical exposure to leasehold issues, landlord and tenant disputes, easements and rights of light through a year-long placement at BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team, alongside broader experience in document review, deadline management and client-facing work. Looking for a paralegal role in conveyancing where I can build transactional property experience under close supervision.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across leasehold issues, easements, rights of light and landlord and tenant disputes: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research across multiple property law matters running concurrently
- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records via iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Amended sections of the memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters from instruction through to submission: takes detailed client instructions, prepares correspondence and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points
- Handles matters across housing, welfare benefits, employment, family, debt and consumer law

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Document review, electronic hearing bundles, matter records maintenance (iManage), deadline tracking across concurrent matters, case-file organisation, procedural histories